

/our-process Page edits

Global Metadata Updates

IMPORTANT: Update the page metadata everywhere it appears for this page, including:

- HTML `<title>`
- meta description
- Open Graph title
- Open Graph description
- any page-level SEO/meta config in JavaScript or component metadata for `/our-process`

New Meta Title

Custom Home Building Process Bay Area | Ritz Builders

New Meta Description

Discover how Ritz Builders guides Bay Area homeowners from design to permitting, construction, and final delivery: all in one design-build process.

Hero Section

H1

- **Change:** Building Dreams Made Simple
- **To:** Custom Home Building Process in the Bay Area.

Hero Subtitle

- **Change:** From concept to completion, our seamless process ensures every detail reflects your vision- with clarity, craftsmanship, and care at every stage.
 - **To:** Ritz Builders guides Bay Area homeowners through discovery, architectural design, permitting, pre-construction planning, construction, and final delivery under one architect-led design-build process.
-

Section 2 — “Turning Your Vision Into Reality”

H2

- **Change:** Turning Your Vision Into Reality
- **To:** How the Custom Home Building Process Works

Body Copy

- **Change:** At Ritz Builders, we believe building your dream home should feel inspiring, not overwhelming. Our step-by-step process combines transparent communication, innovative design, and expert craftsmanship to make your journey enjoyable and effortless. Whether you're customizing your first home or crafting your forever retreat, we guide you every step of the way.
- **To:** Building a custom home in the Bay Area requires more than great design. It requires clear planning, disciplined budgeting, permit coordination, and construction management from start to finish. Ritz Builders guides clients through six architect-led phases: discovery, design, permitting, pre-construction, construction, and final delivery.

CTA

- **Change CTA block from:** Start Your Journey with Ritz
- **To:** Schedule a Discovery Conversation

Also:

- do not send this CTA to the contact page
- anchor/jump this CTA to the form at the bottom of this same page

New Section 3 — What Is Architect-Led Design-Build?

H2

What Is Architect-Led Design-Build?

Intro Paragraph

Architect-led design-build is a project delivery approach in which one coordinated team manages both design and construction, with architectural intent guiding the process from early planning through execution. Unlike traditional delivery models that separate architect and builder into different contracts, this approach is designed to strengthen coordination, reduce disconnects, and keep design, documentation, and construction moving in closer alignment. Supported by AIA and DBIA definitions, the core design-build distinction is one contract and one integrated team; Ritz Builders' difference is that the process is led with design intent at the center.

Process Comparison Table

Feature	Architect-Led Design-Build	Traditional Architect + Builder	Contractor-Led Design-Build
Contract structure	One coordinated design-build entity	Separate architect and contractor contracts	One design-build entity
Primary process driver	Architectural intent and build coordination together	Architect leads design first, contractor joins later	Construction team typically leads overall design-build entity
Coordination style	Design and construction are integrated early	Design and construction are more linear and separated	Design and construction are integrated, but the architect may not be the lead relationship
Risk of disconnects	Lower when roles are clearly coordinated early	Higher because design and construction are split into separate relationships	Can be lower than traditional, but depends heavily on how design authority is structured
Why clients choose it	Stronger design continuity with one accountable team	Familiar traditional model with separated roles	Single-source delivery with construction-led management

Closing Paragraph

For Ritz Builders, this matters because the process is not only about delivering a home under one coordinated team, but about protecting the design vision as the project moves from discovery and concept alignment through budgeting, permitting, construction, and final handoff. On this page, the architect-led model is the framework that connects every phase of the process.

Section 3 (Process 01) — Vision and Discovery

Badge

- **Change:** Shaping Your Vision
- **To:** Discovery and Feasibility

H2

- **Change:** Vision & Discovery
- **To:** Vision Alignment & Project Discovery

Subline

- **Change:** Every masterpiece begins with understanding your lifestyle, your needs, and the way you want to live.
- **To:** The most successful custom homes begin with careful alignment. We start by understanding how you want to live, what you want your home to achieve, and what your site can support. This phase brings together lifestyle goals, property realities, and early planning considerations before design moves forward.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Private consultation focused on your goals, lifestyle, and priorities
 - Site review and early property evaluation
 - Discussion of architectural character, layout needs, and long-term functionality
 - Preliminary zoning, lot, and feasibility considerations
 - Clear alignment on scope, direction, and recommended next steps
-

Section 4 (Process 02) — Architectural Design and Concept Development

Badge

- **Change:** Planning with Precision
- **To:** Architectural Design & Alignment

H2

- **Change:** Architectural Design & Concept Development
- **To:** Architectural Design & Concept Alignment

Subline

- **Change:** Where creativity meets technical excellence.

- **To:** This is where your vision begins to take clear architectural shape. We develop the design around how you want to live, how the home should function, and what the site can realistically support, aligning design intent, engineering considerations, and buildability early so the project can move forward with clarity.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Concept design, floor plans, and early exterior direction shaped around your goals
 - Architectural character, layout flow, and functional priorities refined through guided collaboration
 - Early coordination with structural and technical considerations to support smoother execution later
 - 3D visualizations and material direction used to align expectations before permitting and pre-construction
 - A more complete, coordinated design direction that reduces redesign, confusion, and downstream surprises
-

Section 5 (Process 03) — Budgeting

Badge

- **Change:** Precision you can trust
- **To:** Pre-Construction Clarity

H2

- **Change:** Budgeting, Cost Transparency & Timeline Alignment
- **To:** Budget Alignment, Scope Clarity & Timeline Planning

Subline

- **Change:** Nothing begins until every detail is aligned — financially, structurally, and artistically.
- **To:** Before construction begins, the project needs to be aligned not just architecturally, but financially and operationally. This phase translates the design direction into a clearer budget framework, scheduling roadmap, and scope understanding, helping you move forward with more confidence, fewer unknowns, and better control over what comes next.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Detailed budgeting tied to scope, key selections, and construction priorities
- Clear allowances and early cost guidance to support informed decisions before build start

- Preliminary schedule planning built around project scope, permitting, and construction sequencing
 - Coordination between design intent, material expectations, and build realities to reduce downstream revisions
 - A more defined path into permitting and construction with fewer surprises around cost, timing, and scope
-

Section 6 (Process 04) — Permitting, Approvals, and Compliance

Badge

- **Change:** Seamless approvals
- **To:** Permitting & Approvals

H2

- **Change:** Permitting, Approvals & Compliance
- **To:** Permitting, Technical Coordination & Regulatory Compliance

Subline

- **Change:** Handled entirely by us — saving you months.
- **To:** Once the project direction, scope, and early planning are aligned, the next step is preparing the documentation and coordination needed for approvals. We manage the permitting process through organized submissions, technical consultant coordination, and compliance oversight, helping the project move into construction with stronger documentation and fewer avoidable delays.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Preparation and management of permit submissions across architectural, structural, energy, and related requirements
 - Coordination with consultants and technical disciplines needed to support a complete approval package
 - Detailed construction documentation developed to support review, permitting, and build readiness
 - Communication with city departments and reviewers throughout the approval process
 - A more organized path through permitting and compliance so the project can move forward with greater clarity and fewer setbacks
-

Section 7 (Process 05) — Construction Execution

Badge

- **Change:** Crafted With Care
- **To:** Construction & Project Execution

H2

- **Change:** Construction Execution – The Ritz Standard
- **To:** Construction Execution & Project Management

Subline

- **Change:** Where flawless design meets flawless build.
- **To:** With approvals secured, the project moves into construction. This phase is where planning, coordination, and execution come together, managed by a dedicated team that oversees every stage of the build, maintains alignment with the original design intent, and keeps the project moving with structure and accountability.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Dedicated project manager leading day-to-day execution and coordination
- Structured sequencing of construction phases from site preparation through final finishes
- Coordination of trades, materials, and timelines to maintain project momentum
- Ongoing quality control and inspections at key stages of the build
- Regular walkthroughs and updates to keep you informed as the home takes shape
- Continued alignment between design intent and construction execution throughout the process

Section 8 (Process 06) — Real-Time Transparency and Client Communication

Badge

- **Change:** complete clarity zero stress
- **To:** Communication & Project Visibility

H2

- **Change:** real time transparency and client communication
- **To:** Client Communication, Oversight & Project Visibility

Subline

- **Change:** clients always know where their home stands...
- **To:** Throughout construction, clear communication and consistent oversight help keep the project aligned. This phase is focused on giving you visibility into progress, maintaining a dependable point of contact, and ensuring decisions, updates, and next steps are communicated clearly as the home moves toward completion.

Replace All Bullets With:

- One consistent point of contact throughout the construction process
- Regular progress updates and milestone communication as work advances
- Ongoing visibility into project status, scheduling, and key decisions
- Clear coordination around questions, approvals, and issue resolution

Section 9 (Process 07) — Final Details, Artistry, and Delivery

Badge

- **Change:** Every inch perfected
- **To:** Final Review & Handover

H2

- **Change:** Final Details, Artistry & Delivery
- **To:** Final Walkthrough, Closeout & Project Delivery

Subline

- **Change:** Where flawless design meets flawless build.
- **To:** With construction substantially complete, the final phase focuses on review, refinement, and handoff. We walk the home with you, address remaining details, review key systems and finishes, and prepare the project for delivery so the transition from build to move-in feels clear, complete, and well managed.

Replace All Bullets With:

- Final walkthrough to review the home, completed work, and overall readiness
 - Completion of remaining punch items, touch-ups, and closeout details
 - Review of key systems, functions, and final operating components before delivery
 - Confirmation of finish quality, installation completeness, and presentation standards
 - Home orientation and handoff with clear guidance for next steps and ownership
-

FAQ — Replace All Current FAQs With the Following

FAQ 1

- **How does the custom home building process work with Ritz Builders?**

Ritz Builders guides clients through a structured architect-led design-build process that begins with discovery and feasibility, moves into design alignment and pre-construction planning, and then advances through permitting, construction, final walkthrough, and handoff. Each phase is coordinated to keep the project clear, organized, and moving forward with fewer gaps between design and execution.

FAQ 2

- **What is architect-led design-build?**

Architect-led design-build is a project approach in which design and construction are coordinated under one team, with architectural intent guiding the process from early planning through execution. This helps create stronger alignment between how the home is envisioned, how it is documented, and how it is ultimately built.

FAQ 3

- **Do I need a separate architect if I work with Ritz Builders?**

No. Ritz Builders' process is built to coordinate architectural design and construction planning as part of one integrated approach. That allows the project to move forward with fewer disconnects between design decisions, technical requirements, and build execution.

FAQ 4

- **How does Ritz Builders approach budgeting and cost transparency?**

Budgeting is approached as part of pre-construction planning, where scope, selections, and project priorities are reviewed in greater detail before construction begins. The goal is to create clearer alignment around cost expectations, decision points, and project direction so clients can move forward with more confidence and fewer unknowns.

FAQ 5

- **Does Ritz Builders manage permitting and approvals?**

Yes. Ritz Builders manages the permitting process through organized submissions, technical coordination, and communication with the relevant reviewers and departments. This helps the project move into construction with stronger documentation and a more controlled approval path.

FAQ 6

- **How involved will I be during the design and construction process?**
Clients remain involved throughout the process at key decision points, reviews, and approvals. Ritz Builders provides structured communication and guidance so clients can stay informed and engaged without feeling overwhelmed by the day-to-day complexity of the project.

FAQ 7

- **How does Ritz Builders help reduce surprises during construction?**
Ritz Builders reduces surprises by focusing on alignment early — across vision, design direction, scope, budgeting, documentation, and technical coordination before construction begins. A more organized process upfront helps reduce downstream revisions, communication gaps, and avoidable setbacks later in the build.

FAQ 8

- **What happens after construction is complete?**
As construction concludes, the process shifts into final walkthrough, closeout, and handoff. Remaining details are addressed, key systems and finishes are reviewed, and the home is prepared for delivery so ownership begins with greater clarity and confidence.

FAQ Schema — Replace Existing FAQ Schema With This Exact Block

Important:

- This must match the visible FAQ text exactly
- Remove any old FAQ schema
- Only keep one [FAQPage](#) schema block on the page

HTML

None

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clarity and confidence."  
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Final QA Checklist

Before pushing live, confirm all of the following:

- ☐ visible FAQ text matches FAQ schema exactly
- ☐ old FAQ schema has been removed
- ☐ only one FAQPage schema block remains
- ☐ page is indexable (index, follow)
- ☐ no JS/rendering issue is blocking the updated on-page content
- ☐ meta title and meta description are updated everywhere this page outputs metadata
- ☐ section 2 CTA anchors to the form at the bottom of the same page